

GREGG WILLIAMS

Forty Points and One Ugly Ten

Nobody in the field had seen West Cliffs before Sunday, and only one man got round it in the eighties.

Gregg Williams had never laid eyes on West Cliffs before. He went round it in 40 points and a gross 88, the best round of TEG 15's second day. The margin was four points and six shots. Familiarity, on this evidence, is overrated.

The score was built in the middle of the card. Four straight pars from the 4th through the 7th brought him 12 points. A bogey at the 8th was the only shot he dropped in that spell. Two more pars at the 9th and 10th made it six pars in seven holes. It was the golf of a man who had read the course notes and believed them.

Then came the 15th. A par 5, stroke index 16, one of the gentler propositions on the property. He took a 10. There is no charitable reading of a 10 at a stroke index 16 hole, and none is offered here. He simply gathered himself and carried on to the best score of the day by four points and the best gross by six shots, which is an entirely reasonable way to respond to a disaster.

The round kept Williams on top of both the TEG 15 Trophy and the TEG 15 Green Jacket, a lead he had held overnight. Both advantages grew. Nine points in the Trophy, fourteen in the Jacket. Gaps that had been genuinely tight before the round were no longer anything of the sort.

AT A GLANCE
ROUND OF THE DAY Gregg WILLIAMS (40 pts)
TROPHY LEAD Gregg WILLIAMS, 9 ahead
GREEN JACKET LEAD Gregg WILLIAMS, 14 ahead

ROUND STABLEFORD
GW 40 JP 36 DM 33 JB 29 AB 27 SN 26
ROUND GROSS
GW +16 DM +22 JP +25 JB +29 AB +38 SN +43

AFTER R2 • TROPHY
GW 79 JP 70 DM 63 JB 60 AB 57 SN 57
AFTER R2 • GREEN JACKET
GW +33 DM +47 JP +52 JB +56 AB +68 SN +80

TROPHY

The Sixth Undoes Patterson's Fast Start

A birdie at the hardest hole on the course had him level with Gregg Williams after twenty minutes, and he lost four more points by the close.

John Patterson began the second round of TEG 15 five points behind Gregg Williams in the Trophy. He set about the deficit immediately.

It did not begin well. A double bogey at the 1st, a bogey at the 2nd, and the morning looked lost before it started. Then came a birdie at the 3rd, the hardest hole on the West Cliffs course. It drew

him level with Williams at the top of the Trophy. For a few minutes, the tournament had a contest.

Holes 6 to 8 removed it. Patterson dropped eight shots across the three holes, including a quadruple bogey at the 6th. The initiative was handed back with both hands.

By the close, Williams still led both the Trophy and the Green Jacket, and both gaps had widened rather than narrowed. The Trophy deficit went out to nine points. David Mullin's Green Jacket gap grew from eight to fourteen. Patterson's brief share of the lead at West Cliffs remains the high point of the day. It lasted three holes.

WEST CLIFFS

A New Course Collects Its Dues

Nobody in the field had played West Cliffs before Sunday, and only David Mullin got round it in the same number of shots he had needed at Estoril.

West Cliffs Golf Links, on Portugal's Lisbon Coast, made its TEG debut in round 2 of TEG 16. Two holes did almost all the work.

The par-five 6th, stroke index 11, produced four blow-ups in a single round. Alex Baker took 11, a sextuple bogey and his worst score against par of the day. David Mullin and Stuart Neumann both managed quintuple-bogey 10s. John Patterson, showing restraint, settled for a quadruple-bogey 9. Baker's afternoon then unravelled further, a 9 and a 7 completing a stretch of holes 6 to 8 in which he dropped 13 shots and did not record a single net par.

The par-four 17th, stroke index 6, took its turn later. Alex Baker posted a sextuple-bogey 10 there, part of an 11-shot bleed across the closing three holes. Jon Baker went one better, or rather one worse, with a septuple-bogey 11. It was his worst hole of the round, which by that point was a competitive field.

Quality did appear once. At the par-five 15th, one of the easiest holes on the course, David Mullin made an eagle. On that same hole, Gregg Williams made a quintuple-bogey 10. The course was evidently open to interpretation.

WOODEN SPOON

Neumann Inherits the Spoon at the Fourteenth

David Mullin had held the position since the seventeenth hole of the opening round; it took consecutive holes of eleven and nine to shift it.

Stuart Neumann's second round at West Cliffs was not a collapse. A collapse implies a structure that stood first. This was a procession.

It opened at the 4th with a quadruple bogey 8. It deepened at the par-5 13th with a sextuple bogey 11. The decisive damage arrived at the 14th, one of the hardest holes on the course, where a quintuple bogey 9 dropped him to last in the Wooden Spoon standings. He took the position off David Mullin with the gap between them at zero. Nobody wants to win anything by that margin.

The closing stretch offered no relief and, one suspects, was never going to. A double bogey at the 16th. Another quintuple bogey at the 17th. A double bogey at the 18th to finish. Nine shots bled over the last three holes, delivered with the unhurried consistency of a man who had stopped negotiating.

He signed for 26 points, matching the worst Trophy score of the round, and a gross 115. It was his first visit to West Cliffs. The course will remember him.

RECORDS & PERSONAL BESTS

Notable achievements: TEG 15, Round 2

RARE FEATS

- David Mullin eagles the par-5 15th (R2)
- Alex Baker runs up an 11 (+6) at the 6th — his career-worst on a par-5
- Jon Baker runs up an 11 (+7) at the 17th — his career-worst on a par-4